Derick Janssen

An award-winning gameplay programmer who is passionate about gameplay, feel, tools, performance, and multiplayer. Excels at rapid prototyping and communication.

EXPERIENCE

Santa Barbara Games, Remote — *Principal Engineer*
Jan 2025 - Current

Wicked Fox Games, Remote — *Senior/Lead Programmer*
May 2024 - Jan 2026

Studio Wildcard, Remote — *Senior Programmer*
Feb 2024 - May 2024

Bethesda Game Studios, Dallas, TX — *Senior/Lead Programmer*
June 2016 - January 2024

S2 Games, Kalamazoo, MI — *Senior Programmer*
June 2012 - June 2016

Evolutionary Games, Orlando, FL — *Programmer*
July 2008 - May 2010

EDUCATION

SMU Guildhall, TX — *Interactive Technology - 3.5*
2010-2012, Full Scholarship Awarded
An intense masters program where we built our own engine and renderer from the ground up. We also learned and created multiple games in different engines (Torque, UDK, and proprietary engines)

UCF, FL — *BS Computer Science - 3.64*
2007 - 2010, Presidents List
UCF combined Electrical Engineering and Computer Science so I learned a lot about Electrical Engineering as well as Computer Science while taking a focus on Artificial Intelligence (even graduate level) courses

YouTube and other Media
Always - Forever
I follow all sorts of programming and math/science channels! Tell me your favorites. Always stay learning and curious!

Email: zorakbane@yahoo.com
This resume was created by a human for humans. Please ask for the AI one.

SKILLS

Agentic Coding, AI (general)
Unreal, Unity, XNA, Torque

AWARDS

Finalist in the Indie Games Challenge
Galactic Arms Race

Full Scholarship Awarded to SMU Guildhall
from Indie Games Challenge at DICE convention 2010 in Las Vegas

Upsilon Pi Epsilon
Member of the Computer Science honors society

Pi Mu Epsilon
Member of the Mathematics honors society

Steam VR Game of the Year & Golden Joystick Award
Skyrim VR 2018

XBox Game of the Year & Most Innovative Gameplay Award
Starfield 2023

LANGUAGES

C++ C# C
Lua, ActionScript, Blueprint
Java, or whatever language

English
Some Spanish
Some Japanese

SPEECHES

KVCC - Game industry primer · GR Dev Night - Game development (sold out) · MSU - How to transition

from education to industry · WMU - So you want to make games? · UCF - Galactic Arms Race - NEAT(AI) and Making games with it

OTHER DEVELOPMENTS

Project M(3.0) — Wii Homebrew App - Front end launcher and updater · UEFN Game prototyping, many games in UEFN · **Ninja Survivors** - UE5 - Lead Programmer - a Vampire Survivors clone done in Unreal GAS · **Alchemy Avenue** - UE4 - Lead Programmer - a mobile game done in blueprint to teach covid19 furloughed friends game development. · **NFC Amiibo data** — a github I started to reverse engineer Amiibos and their data · Game Jams! I try to do at least a game jam a year.

PROJECTS (Reverse Chronological)

- **Voidwood** — *Unity C#* — Owner of the Deterministic Multiplayer Rollback Netcode simulation in ECS. Created a V-Rising size world with a mean simulation time of ~1.5ms. Ensured a performant build with no crashes or desyncs and at each milestone. Created many tools for the team and productivity. Created Agentic AI workflows for non-coders.
- **Rise of Elements** — *Unity C#* — I worked on client/server game logic, UI, and tools. I've worked on nearly every aspect of the game except backend AWS server scaling.
- **Ark Survival Ascended** — *UE5 C++* — I helped with optimization, tools, and bug fixes. I gained 25% server performance in my first week! I identified problems with nanite/Lumen performance that severely limited client framerate.
- **Starfield** — *Proprietary C++ Engine* — I worked as a lead for the StarMap feature. I later worked on Ship Building, Localization, Optimizations, and Outposts.
- **Fallout 76** — *Proprietary C++ Engine* — I was brought on to ship some post release features, namely bulldozing, vending, and camp decorating. I also worked on the Nuclear Winter game mode.
- **Skyrim VR** — *Proprietary C++ Engine* — I spearheaded this VR project from conception until launch. I worked on pretty much every feature of the game except the zoomed out map mode and tutorial.
- **Galactic Arms Race** — *XNA* — A multiplayer Diablo-esque looter shooter and a thesis for cgNeat (content generation with AI). I worked on a number of gameplay elements and integrated ANN to gameplay.

Game Jams: I try to do at least a game jam a year. Selected titles and details: [derickjanssen.com]() and [Global Game Jam]().